

PLUGGED IN? An EV charging station at Sector 18, Gurugram, Haryana

TRANSPORT / **EV INFRA**

BATTLING RANGE ANXIETY

Inadequate charging infrastructure threatens to put the brakes on India's electric vehicles ambitions

By AVISHEK G. DASTIDAR

BENGALURU-BASED ZORAVAR ALI (NAME CHANGED), AN EXECUTIVE WITH A TELECOM FIRM, HAD JUST BOUGHT HIMSELF A BYD ATTO 3, a compact SUV electric vehicle, and was really looking forward to a road trip with best pal Rahul Bajpayee (*name changed*) last July. Rahul, who had just come down from Delhi, had a work meet in Chennai, so that is where the two set off for. Things seemed smooth for the first 250-odd kilometres on the 340km-long journey along NH44 and NH48 via Kanchipuram. But then it was time to charge the battery. They found a charging point soon enough. But it was only of 20kW capacity and would have taken more than an hour to bring the battery to full